Project Charter and Scope Definition

PROJECT NAME	PROJECT MANAGER	PROJECT SPONSOR
VMS: Phish-Guard Advanced Phishing Simulation & Training Portal	Kamira Sherman	Dr. James Barker

EMAIL	ORGANIZATIONAL UNIT(S)
[email redacted]	Capella University – Master of Science in Information Technology (MSIT) Capstone
[email redacted]	Capella University

Project Overview

TEAM MISSION	The VMS Phish-Guard project team is committed to designing and delivering an ethical, secure, and educational phishing simulation platform that improves cybersecurity awareness through realistic phishing simulations, immediate learning opportunities, and measurable reporting. The team will collaborate using Agile project management principles, maintain open communication with stakeholders, and continuously improve the solution throughout each sprint (Project Management Institute, 2021).
TEAM VALUES	Collaboration through shared ownership and accountability. Transparent communication and timely escalation of risks. Ethical cybersecurity practices and responsible handling of data. Continuous improvement through Agile feedback and sprint retrospectives. Respect for diverse perspectives and professional conduct.
PROJECT OVERVIEW	Phish-Guard is a phishing awareness and training portal designed to help organizations evaluate employee awareness through safe, controlled phishing simulations. The application enables administrators to create phishing awareness campaigns, manage approved recipients, track user interaction events, and deliver educational content following simulated phishing engagements. The solution emphasizes ethical cybersecurity practices by avoiding the collection of user credentials while providing meaningful reporting and awareness metrics to support organizational security training (National Institute of Standards and Technology, 2024).
PROBLEM STATEMENT	Organizations continue to face phishing-driven security risks because employees may not recognize deceptive emails, unsafe links, or suspicious credential prompts. Human error continues to be one of the leading contributors to cybersecurity incidents, making phishing awareness and security education essential components of organizational risk management (Verizon, 2025). Without a controlled and ethical way to test awareness and provide timely training, companies may have limited visibility into employee readiness and recurring human-risk patterns.
PURPOSE OF PROJECT	The purpose of this project is to create a structured phishing simulation and training portal that supports awareness testing, event tracking, and immediate education. The project will help organizations identify phishing susceptibility

	trends while reinforcing secure behavior through brief, practical training content.
BUSINESS CASE	A controlled phishing simulation platform can help organizations reduce human-centered security risk by measuring user interaction with simulated phishing attempts and delivering corrective education at the moment of engagement. By avoiding the collection of real credentials and focusing on awareness, reporting, and training, Phish-Guard supports safer testing practices while giving organizations actionable insight into workforce security readiness (Verizon, 2025; National Institute of Standards and Technology [NIST], 2024).
GOALS / METRICS	• Configure a safe phishing simulation workflow capable of sending realistic training emails in a controlled environment. • Create landing pages that track clicks or visits without collecting, storing, or displaying actual passwords. • Document event-tracking requirements for clicks, landing-page visits, training completion, and quiz outcomes. • Design a short education module that can be triggered after a user clicks a simulated phishing link. • Develop a 2-minute interactive quiz that teaches users how they could have identified the simulated phishing email. • Maintain weekly team progress updates and bi-weekly client check-ins with Dr. James Barker. • Deliver project artifacts aligned with course expectations, Agile sprint planning, and team role accountability. • Complete all planned sprint deliverables by scheduled sprint reviews. • Maintain 100% documentation of project decisions, risks, and backlog changes in Jira. • Receive client approval for all major sprint deliverables. • Successfully demonstrate end-to-end phishing simulation functionality during the final presentation.
DEFINITION OF DONE	A backlog item or project deliverable will be considered complete when it meets all the following criteria: • Functional requirements have been implemented and successfully tested. • Code has been peer reviewed by at least one team member. • Security and ethical requirements have been verified, including protection against unauthorized credential collection. • Supporting documentation has been updated and closed. • Any identified defects have been resolved or documented for future work. • Deliverables requiring stakeholder review have been demonstrated to and accepted by the client
EXPECTED DELIVERABLES	• Phish-Guard phishing awareness application supporting campaign management, recipient management, safe click tracking, educational content delivery, reporting capabilities, and administrative documentation. • Safe credential-harvesting-style landing page that records interaction events only and does not capture real passwords. • Event tracking/reporting approach for simulation engagement. • Security awareness content and phishing indicators developed by the Security Content Creator. • Interactive phishing awareness education module and quiz • Technical documentation, project status updates, backlog, and final

	recommendations.

PROJECT SCOPE

WITHIN SCOPE	The Phish-Guard project will design, develop, and document a secure phishing simulation and awareness training platform for educational purposes. The project encompasses requirements gathering, system design, frontend and backend development, security awareness content creation, reporting capabilities, testing, Agile project management, and technical documentation. The solution will be developed within the constraints of the Capella MSIT Capstone and will not extend into production deployment or operational support. • Configuration, testing, enhancement, and documentation of the Phish-Guard phishing awareness application • Safe simulated email and landing-page workflow • Click and visit tracking without real credential capture • Education Module and quiz design for phishing awareness • Role-based task execution across frontend, backend, systems, content, and project management • Documentation of requirements, backlog, risks, and sprint progress
OUTSIDE OF SCOPE	• Sending phishing simulations to real employees without documented authorization • Capturing, storing, or exposing actual user passwords or sensitive credentials • Conducting live phishing campaigns outside the approved academic/project environment • Deploying the platform into a production enterprise environment • Long-term monitoring, commercial rollout, or post-course support • Legal, HR, or disciplinary actions based on simulation results

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES	• **Front End Developer** – Designs and supports the user-facing portal components, landing-page experience, reporting dashboard, and education module interface. Also assists with testing and user interface improvements. **Eddie Valdes** • **Backend Developer** – Supports server-side functionality, event-tracking logic, data flow, and integration between simulation activities and reporting. Collaborates with the team on system configuration and deployment activities previously assigned to the Systems Administrator role. **Aron**

Queen

- **Security Content & Governance** – Develops phishing awareness content, simulated email indicators, quiz questions, user education materials, and supports security documentation and governance deliverables. **John Milling**
- **Project Manager / Scrum Master** – Coordinates project activities, facilitates sprint planning, reviews and retrospectives, maintains the Jira backlog, tracks risks and dependencies, manages client communications with Dr. James Barker, and supports system administration planning and documentation as needed. **Kamira Sherman**
- **Shared Systems Administration Responsibilities** – Following the departure of two team members after ITEC 5900, the remaining team members have agreed to collaboratively assume the responsibilities previously assigned to the Systems Administrator role. These responsibilities include environment configuration support, hosting considerations, access management, deployment planning, operational documentation, and other infrastructure-related activities. Task ownership will be assigned during Sprint Planning and tracked through Jira.
- **Team Members** – Attend meetings, complete assigned work, communicate blockers early, participate in peer reviews, and contribute to continuous improvement. **All Team Members**

CLIENT MEETING PLAN

Meeting Frequency
Bi-weekly Wednesdays with Dr. James Barker
Weekly internal Saturday meeting

Agenda
Current items
PLUS

- Review completed sprint goals
- Review outstanding action items
- Validate backlog priorities
- Identify risks
- Review change requests
- Confirm acceptance criteria

Deliverables Following Each Meeting

- Meeting minutes
- Updated Jira backlog
- Action item log
- Updated risk register
- Client status report

COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

Communication	Purpose	Frequency
Jira	Task Tracking	Daily
Courseroom	Assignment Collaboration	Weekly
Email	Client Communication	As Needed

TEAM RESOURCE UPDATE

Zoom	Client and Team Meetings	Bi-Weekly for client and Weekly Team Meetings
WhatsApp	Team coordination	As needed

- Following the completion of ITEC 5900, two team members elected not to continue with ITEC 5905. Rather than replacing these members, the remaining team agreed to redistribute the associated responsibilities across the existing team. This collaborative approach maintains project continuity while leveraging each team member's strengths. Work assignments will continue to be reviewed during Sprint Planning and managed through Jira to ensure balanced workloads and timely completion of project deliverables.

RISKS, CONSTRAINTS, AND ASSUMPTIONS

RISKS

Risk	Probability	Impact	Owner	Mitigation
Ethical misuse of phishing	Medium	High	Project Manager	Require client approval and maintain no-credential collection policy
Technical integration issues	Medium	High	Backend Developer	Incremental testing and Sprint Reviews
Team Availability	Medium	Medium	Project Manager	Capacity planning and workload redistribution
Scope Changes	Medium	Medium	Entire team	Client approval and backlog refinement
Scheule Delays	Low	High	Project Manager	Weekly progress Reviews and

					early escalation

CONSTRAINTS	• Fixed academic timeline • Course/Project Environment • Four-member team following staffing changes • Academic semester timeline • Limited testing environment • Educational use only • No production deployment
ASSUMPTIONS	• Remaining team members will share systems administration responsibilities. • Client feedback will remain available throughout the semester. • Jira will remain the primary work management platform. • Sprint commitments will be reviewed weekly • Systems administration responsibilities will be shared collaboratively among the team and assigned during Sprint Planning based on workload and individual strengths. • Dr. James Barker will continue providing guidance and feedback throughout the project and will review major deliverables, scope changes, and client-facing decisions as needed.
STATEMENT OF ADAPTABILITY	• **This charter is a living document.** Since transitioning from ITEC 5900 to ITEC 5905, the project team has experienced changes in team membership. To maintain project continuity, the remaining team members have redistributed responsibilities, including those previously assigned to the Systems Administrator role. The team will continuously inspect and adapt project plans during Sprint Planning, Sprint Reviews, and Sprint Retrospectives. Changes to scope, staffing, priorities, or technical implementation will be documented in Jira and communicated to the client for review when appropriate, consistent with Agile project management principles (PMI, 2021).
DECISION MAKING	• Project decisions will be made collaboratively whenever possible. Technical decisions will be discussed during team meetings, with consensus serving as the preferred approach. When consensus cannot be reached, the Project Manager will facilitate discussion and document the final decision after considering team input and client requirements. Changes affecting approved project scope, security controls, major deliverables, or project schedule require client review and approval. Internal task assignments,

	documentation updates, and implementation decisions may be approved by the project team.

PREPARED BY	TITLE	DATE
KAMIRA SHERMAN	Project Manager/Scrum Master	7/22/26

References

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